Office of Information Technology Services

State Capitol P.O. Box 2062
Albany, NY 12220-0062
www.its.ny.gov

New York State Information Technology Policy	**No:** ITS-P24-003
IT Policy: **Process for Establishing Information Technology Policies, Standards, and Guidelines**	**Updated:** 07/10/2024 **Issued By:** NYS Office of Information Technology Services **Owner:** Division of Legal Affairs

1.0 Purpose and Benefits

This policy sets forth the process for how the New York State Office of Information Technology Services (ITS) develops, updates, and publishes information technology policies, standards, and guidelines.

A cohesive process for the development of policies, standards, and guidelines promotes:

- alignment with the agency's mission, vision, and strategic priorities;
- consistent formatting and professional presentation; and
- efficient, effective, and transparent operations.

2.0 Authority

Section 1 of Executive Order No. 117[1], issued January 2002, charges the State Chief Information Officer with overseeing and supervising the management and operations of the Office of Information Technology Services (ITS). *Section 102(2) of the State Technology Law* gives the Director of ITS responsibility for the administration of ITS. Details regarding this authority can be found in NYS-P08-002 Authority to Establish State Enterprise Information Technology (IT) Policy, Standards and Guidelines.

3.0 Scope

This policy applies to ITS and its employees, contractors, and consultants.

4.0 Information Statement

All ITS policies, standards, and guidelines shall be established and updated in accordance with this policy.

4.1 Classification

All documents are classified into three categories and three forms.

Category

1. Statewide documents: These apply to all State Entities, their employees, as well as all consultants, vendors, and contractors of the State Entities that use or access any ITS Information Technology Resource for which ITS has administrative responsibility, including systems managed or hosted by third-parties on behalf of ITS. Examples include processing of State data or security practices.
2. ITS Supported Agency documents: These apply to ITS and the agencies ITS supports (i.e., Client Agencies) including their consultants, vendors, or contractors who have access to or manage Client Agency information or data. Examples include domain address requirements and universal navigation.
3. Internal documents: These apply to all ITS employees, and may apply to ITS consultants, vendors, or contractors who have access to or manage State Entity information and/or ITS supported agencies. Examples include work rules or building access requirements.

Form

1. Policy: A formal, high-level statement that outlines an organization's general beliefs, values, goals, objectives, and expectations for a specified subject area. Compliance with a policy is required.
2. Standard: A directive, mandatory action, rule, or norm surrounding a particular practice. A standard can be a standalone document or make a policy more meaningful and effective by including accepted specifications for hardware, software, or behavior. Compliance with a standard is required.
3. Guideline: Guidance, best practices, recommendations, or administrative instructions to perform a specific task. A guideline can be a standalone document or make a policy or standard more meaningful and effective. Compliance with a guideline is not compulsory, but strongly suggested.

4.2 Development

Using the most current template, the policy, standard, or guideline must include, at a minimum, the following sections in this exact order:

1.0 Purpose and Benefits

Clear statement of the objective and benefits of the policy, standard, or guideline.

2.0 Authority

Specific reference to the law, rule, regulation, executive order, technical standard, or control agency (e.g., Office of the Attorney General or Office of the State Comptroller) directive in support of the document.

3.0 Scope

Description of the target audience to which the policy, standard, or guideline applies.

4.0 Information Statement

Formal outline of expectations, acceptable behavior, preferred methodology, or detailed actions required of the target audience.

5.0 Compliance

Identification of the effective date of the document, the date that compliance will be expected, if applicable, and the exception reporting instructions if appropriate.

6.0 Definitions of Key Terms

All documents must include a link to the ITS online glossary and all terms must be included.

7.0 Contact Information

Owner contact information to promote direct communication with the target audience.

8.0 Revision History

Outline of the prescribed review period and all previous modifications of the document.

9.0 Related Documents

References and links to additional documents, source information, or resources on the subject matter.

4.3 Numbering

All policies, standards, and guidelines receive a unique reference number prior to publication; therefore, only the ITS Division of Legal Affairs (DLA) may assign reference numbers to documents. Each reference number consists of a three character category code, a one character form code, two digit year code, and a three digit sequential number. For example, this policy's reference number is NYS-P09-003.

Category Code

- NYS – Statewide document
- ITS – ITS Supported Agency documents and Internal documents

Form Code

- P – Policy
- S – Standard
- G – Guideline

4.4 Approval

The draft policy, standard, or guideline must be vetted using ITS' established internal review process. DLA will review all policies, standards, and guidelines for suitability and

consistency with all applicable laws, rules, and regulations. All policies, standards, and guidelines must receive all necessary ITS executive approvals prior to being finalized and sent for publication.

4.5 Publication

The ITS Public Information Office must review all policies, standards, and guidelines for compliance with formatting and branding guidelines.

The policy, standard, or guideline is published at the following locations based on category:

Statewide documents
ITS public website and ITS Inside Edge

ITS Supported Agency documents and Internal documents
ITS Inside Edge and, where applicable, the ITS public website

Additional communication correspondence may be utilized for publication purposes.

4.6 Rescission

If the subject matter of a policy, standard, or guideline is neither relevant nor aligns with strategic priorities, becomes obsolete due to changes in law, technology, or a division reorganization, or is more logically combined with another policy, standard, or guideline, the document may be rescinded.

A policy, standard, or guideline may be rescinded with a written directive to DLA from the owner, with the approval of the ITS General Counsel. Any references to the rescinded policy, standard, or guideline that exist in related documents or the agency's websites should be removed or updated. The corresponding reference number will not be used for any subsequent policy, standard, or guideline.

4.7 Periodic Review

Owners are required to periodically perform a thorough review of their policies, standards, and guidelines to ensure relevancy and proper branding updates at least once every three years. Owners must also review any applicable glossary terms when reviewing their policies, standards, and guidelines to ensure continued relevancy.

Owners must take care that their policies, standards, and guidelines continue to be relevant during the interim periods between reviews. Changes in law, rule, regulation, guidance, policy, and technology may necessitate changes to ITS policies, standards, and guidelines. If changes are needed, owners can submit revised policies, standards, and guidelines to DLA for off-cycle reviews.

Material changes or enhancements to existing policies, standards, or guidelines are subject to the approval process as outlined in section 4.4 of this policy.

Periodic review cycles will continue in the event of an extraordinary circumstance impacting agency operations, to the extent practicable, using virtual meetings and other electronic collaboration tools, as applicable.

5.0 Compliance

This policy shall take effect upon publication. Compliance is required with all ITS policies and standards. ITS may amend its policies and standards at any time; compliance with amended policies and standards is required.

6.0 Definitions of Key Terms

Except for terms defined in this policy, all terms shall have the meanings found in the ITS Glossary.

7.0 Contact Information

Submit all inquiries and requests for future enhancements to the owner at:

Division of Legal Affairs
Reference: ITS-P24-003
NYS Office of Information Technology Services
State Capitol, ESP, P.O. Box 2062
Albany, NY 12220
Telephone: (518) 473-5115
Email: its.sm.dla@its.ny.gov

The State of New York Enterprise IT Policies may be found at the following website:
https://its.ny.gov/policies

8.0 Revision History

This policy should be reviewed consistent with the requirements set forth in ITS-P24-003 Process for Establishing Information Technology Polices, Standards and Guidelines.

Date	Description of Change	Reviewer
04/04/2002	Original policy release	OFT
10/01/2009	Revised policy	CIO/OFT
01/15/2010	Revised to correct formatting and technical errors	CIO/OFT
12/04/2017	Revised policy	Internal Controls Office
12/27/2019	Revised policy to include new authority and scope language and clarify form definitions.	Internal Controls Office
05/04/2021	Revised to include process during extraordinary circumstances.	Internal Controls Office

05/24/2021	Updated Scope Language	Internal Controls Office
07/10/2024	Changed from External to Internal	Division of Legal affairs

9.0 Related Documents

NYS-P08-002 Authority to Establish Enterprise Information Technology Policies, Standards, and Guidelines